

Early videophone and visualphone



(a)



(b)

Figure 4.2 (a) One of British Telecom's early videophones and (b) an early mobile visualphone developed in Japan

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VideoWindow system (Bellcore, 1989)

- Shared space that allowed people 50 miles apart to carry on a conversation as if in same room drinking coffee together
- 3 x 8 ft 'picture-window' between two sites with video and audio
- People did interact via the window but strange things happened (Kraut, 1990)

Sketch of VideoWindow



Findings of how VideoWindow System was used

- Talked constantly about the system
- Spoke more to other people in the same room rather than in other room
- When tried to get closer to someone in other place had opposite effect - went out of range of camera and microphone
- No way of monitoring this

Skype success

- Global household name
- Seeing others on screen enables more intimacy than audio phone
- Enables people to get to know each other better
- Less awkward for young children
 - Like “to show, not tell” (Ames et al, 2010)

3D virtual worlds

- Second Life (2007)
 - Over 8 million users
- What kinds of conversation take place in these environments?
- VoIP versus chatroom talk?
 - Which is preferred and why?

Facebook and Twitter

- Everyone uses them so what is there to learn?
- Used in emergencies, demos, etc.,
 - e.g., users spread up-to-the minute info and retweet about how a wildfire or gas plume is moving
 - but can also start or fuel rumours, by adding news that is old or incorrect
 - more confusing than helpful